



**MINUTES
MEETING OF THE SUNRISE CITY COMMISSION**

**Thursday, September 12, 2024
5:30 p.m.**

1. Call to Order

Mayor Ryan called the meeting to order at 5:32 p.m.

2. Roll Call

BY: City Clerk Felicia Bravo

Those found to be present were:

Mayor Michael Ryan
Deputy Mayor Joseph Scuotto
Assistant Deputy Mayor Neil Kerch
Commissioner Mark Douglas
Commissioner Jacqueline Guzman

City Manager Mark Lubelski
Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith
City Attorney Thomas Moss
Finance and Administrative Services Director Susan Nabors
Budget Manager Kareyann Ashworth
Administrative Aide Lourdes Lawrence
City Clerk Felicia Bravo

3. Moment of Silence and Pledge of Allegiance

All were in favor of a motion to dispense.

City Commission Meeting
First Budget Hearing FY 2024/2025
September 12, 2024

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch asked his colleagues for the presentation to be completed prior to questions being asked of staff. He requested that courtesy.

4. Open Discussion

No one came forward to speak.

5. Public Hearings

(A) Tentative Millage Rates
C24227 Resolution No. 24-84-24-A

A Resolution of the City of Sunrise, Florida, adopting a Tentative Millage Rate; authorizing the Levy of 6.0543 Mills Ad Valorem Tax (\$6.0543 per \$1,000 of assessed value) on all Taxable Real and Personal Property within the City; authorizing the Levy of .3188 Mills Ad Valorem Tax (\$.3188 per \$1,000 of assessed value) on all taxable real and personal property within the city, for funds for the annual debt service of the City of Sunrise, Florida, General Obligation Bonds for Fiscal Year 2024/2025; and providing for an effective date. City Manager Mark Lubelski. Susan Nabors, Director of Finance and Administrative Services.

MOTION A motion to approve Item 5A made by Deputy Mayor Scuotto was seconded by Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch.

(E) Budget FY 2024/2025¹
C24223

Commission discussion and/or action re: First Reading of an Ordinance of the City of Sunrise, Florida, making Appropriations for the General Fund, Water, Wastewater, Gas, Stormwater and other Enterprise Funds, and various other City Funds for the Fiscal Year 2024/2025 based upon the estimates of revenues and requested appropriations as submitted by the City Manager; adopting a Personnel Summary for Fiscal Year 2024/2025; reducing the Economic Development Fund Balance established by Resolution No. 11-122; providing for conflict; providing for severability; and providing an effective date. City Manager Mark Lubelski. Susan Nabors, Director of Finance and Administrative Services.

MOTION A motion to approve Item 5E made by Deputy Mayor Scuotto was seconded by Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch.

Mayor Ryan announced that there would be a simultaneous public hearing on Items 5A and 5E. City staff would make a brief presentation and then he would open the public hearings.

¹ Item 5E was heard simultaneously with Item 5A and moved up on the agenda.

Budget Manager Kareyann Ashworth stated the proposed ad valorem tax levy passed by the City of Sunrise, City Commission on July 9, 2024 for FY 2024/2025 was 6.0543 mills. This millage rate was 0.4639 mills or 8.30% more than the rolled-back rate of 5.5904 mills. The increase is related to various personnel and operating cost increases. Staff recommended that a tentative millage levy of 6.0543 mills be passed. Additionally, staff computed the tentative millage needed to fund the FY 2024/2025 voted debt service tax levy for the General Obligation Bonds. The voted debt service tax levy needed was .3188 mills. Because this was a voted debt service tax levy, no rolled-back rate calculation is required. Staff recommended that a tentative voted debt service tax levy of .3188 mills be passed.

City Manager/Budget Staff Presentation

City Manager Mark Lubelski gave a statement regarding the budget and the importance of economic development on the financial health of the City.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith stated the total budget for all funds was \$520.8 million, with the following major funding categories:

- General Fund -\$184.7 million
- Water & Wastewater Operating -\$137.8 million
- Water & Wastewater Capital Improvement Projects -\$15.2 million
- Gas Operating -\$11.7 million
- Stormwater -\$10.6 million
- Fleet Management -\$12.3 million
- IT & Communications -\$10.7 million
- Building -\$10.2 million
- Self-Insured Health -\$20.2 million

The proposed millage rate was 6.0543 Mills for the 16th consecutive year, which was 8.30% over roll-back rate of 5.5904 mills. Taxable property values increased by 8.90%, including \$60.1 million in new construction. The Sunrise Residential Fire Assessment Fee would be \$279.50. The budget was structurally balanced for the 10th consecutive year.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith and City Manager Mark Lubelski provided detail while proceeding through the budget presentation related to major changes.

Mayor Ryan opened the simultaneous public hearings on Items 5A and 5E. No one came forward.

Mayor Ryan closed the public hearings.

Mayor Ryan went through the presentation page by page.

City Commission Meeting
First Budget Hearing FY 2024/2025
September 12, 2024

Deputy Mayor Scuotto stated there was a service that let people know that emergency vehicles were in the area.

Fire Chief John McNamara stated the City already had that.

Pages 3-4

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch was for the webchat feature. He saw an economic development decrease. He asked for the reason.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith explained there were funds that were not used or needed next year for video production. The videographer was now on board. His name is John McCall.

Commissioner Guzman said the Commission was not notified he was now on board.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto agreed with the web chat software to respond to questions would be helpful to people who spoke different languages. He stated he has called many times in the middle of the night. This would be good for the residents.

Commissioner Douglas asked about the projected income interest. He thought that the City was receiving about 5% annually. He wanted to know where the money was put.

City Manager Mark Lubelski said if there was additional revenue it would go into the general fund balance.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith elaborated that it would go into the general fund balance.

Commissioner Douglas asked why the City was being so conservative with its estimate. He asked if the projection was reasonable. He asked about money being allocated when it was received.

City Manager Mark Lubelski said that the projection was less than last year because they believed that the interest rates would go down. They did not want to over-project and come up short. Any dollars would go into the general fund for the next fiscal year.

Commissioner Douglas stated there was \$2 million last year, but it was budgeted at \$1.1 million. It was the same the year before as well. This year's projection was \$5 million. He wanted to make sure that the projection was correct.

City Manager Mark Lubelski responded that the interest rates did not fall last year, but the City was expecting the rate to fall.

Commissioner Douglas asked where in the budget was the money being spent.

City Manager Mark Lubelski explained there was a basket of revenue. They used the money across the budget.

Commissioner Douglas did not see the money on the expenditure side.

City Manager Mark Lubelski replied it was not assigned to anything specific.

Commissioner Douglas explained the revenue versus expenditure balances. It was not budgeted for last year, so he wanted to know how it was spent.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith responded that some revenues came in lower than expected and the overages covered those as well.

Page 5

Mayor Ryan thought that web chatting AI needed to be beta tested to avoid embarrassment as well as a survey that the departments received. Everyone loved the intern programs in the City, but he would like to see the successes of programs.

City Manager Mark Lubelski said there would be an interim report regarding interns.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto commented about the steps for the Deputy Directors. He would have liked to have the information prior to the budget hearing.

City Manager Mark Lubelski clarified that the other Charter Officers' budgets were independent from the City Manager's.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto stated that the City Clerk's Office was asking for a position. He asked City Manager about it from a budgetary perspective.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch stated he spoke with Ms. Bravo regarding the budget. There were concerns about funding for the new mobility board.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith advised there was significant funding for the board.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch stated that recording documents and legal advertising were legally required. He asked if there was sufficient funding for those accounts.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith replied that she believed that it was sufficient, but she would check and report back at the next meeting.

Commissioner Douglas hoped that the need for an additional person would have been brought to his attention earlier. The role has shifted and there was some additional work that came with the additional boards. He did not see anything else that indicated what this role would do. He thought that the public records requests were more like pass-throughs. He did not want the public to think there was an opportunistic grab for an increase in salaries. The proposed salary increase at the same time as the City Manager could have been coincidental. He thought the timing was odd, given that the predecessor was in the role for such a long time. If it was truly needed, he thought that the position should have been increased in pay last year or the year before. He wished it had been brought forward earlier.

Commissioner Guzman had the same concern that Meryl had been here for years and now it was being changed. She asked City Clerk Felicia Bravo to justify the increase in pay for the Deputy City Clerk position and for the additional position.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo explained that an Administrative Officer needed to take over some of the daily work that was performed by Deputy City Clerk Meryl Girard and herself. Handling the daily tasks prevented the office from instituting other needed changes to bring the office to a higher level. City Clerk Felicia Bravo detailed eight initiatives that she thought would improve the office and customer experience. City Clerk Felicia Bravo added that she gave up a position previously in order to help the City through a difficult economic time, but now needed a position added back due to the increased workload and its complexity. She apologized for not bringing the matter forward earlier; however, she had mentioned some of the initiatives and the additional staff to Commissioner Guzman in October 2023. At the time, she agreed an additional staff member was needed.

Commissioner Guzman asked how long it would take to vet a new system, because once it was up and running, it would operate itself.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo responded there is no software system that took care of itself. Intervention and maintenance were always required.

Commissioner Guzman said it seemed like once the initiatives were in place, the additional staff was not fully justified.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo replied that the office did not have time to address these initiatives due to staffing issues. While the office had four employees, many times the office ran with only two or three people. If there was no work for an additional employee, she would not continue with the additional staffing.

Commissioner Guzman asked when the office conducted public records training for staff.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo answered the training was conducted for each department individually two years ago in preparation for the move to the new city hall.

Commissioner Guzman responded that she thought the training was prompted by the “incident” earlier in the year.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo replied that was not the case.

Commissioner Guzman replied that for the amount of money each of the employees in the City Clerk’s Office were making that they should expect a workload, especially with their education. Commissioner Guzman stated she reached out to other cities to find out what their city clerks did. There were many things those offices did that the City Clerk’s Office did not. This work was being given to other departments that this department was not doing. A discussion needed to take place. They needed to see what was being done, not being done and what the office wanted to do.

Mayor Ryan agreed with City Clerk Felicia Bravo that over the years the complexity of the tasks had changed. The City was more complex and the records requests were more frequent. He recognized that City Clerk Felicia Bravo was a stickler for precision and that was necessary to keep the City out of court. Her decision was to assist the City and get by over the past ten years. He thought it would be helpful to outline in a memo the items that she would like to explore and what other city clerks’ offices did. The boards had grown quite a bit since 2014. He knew it was a full-time job to complete the board process. He would have liked the information sooner, but would requested the memo.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo also added that the position would also provide for succession planning.

Mayor Ryan agreed.

Commissioner Douglas thought that the questions were legitimate. If these matters were addressed earlier, there would not be a need to cover it now. Other clerks’ offices handled the agenda and supervised the commission staff. There was differentiation everywhere and not every job was the same. He would have

liked to have seen the functions that were in the other offices and the typical rates of pay in those departments. The agenda would require a whole new person. It was not in her office.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo answered that many city clerks' offices were structured differently. Some had business tax receipts, some did cemetery plots, some reported to the city manager, while others reported to the city commission.

Commissioner Douglas continued that Commissioner Guzman suggested that the public records training was a result of an incident. Commissioner Douglas suggested that it was implemented due to some shortcomings. It went through the City Attorney's Office. He thought that it was the genesis for the training.

City Clerk Felicia Bravo responded that she had a PowerPoint presentation that she created on November 18, 2015 for public records training. There was training held in 2018 as well.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch commented that he believed that City Clerk Felicia Bravo justified the position.

Commissioner Guzman stated that that the suggested initiatives sounded good. She said things were being done in other city clerks' offices that were not being done in Sunrise. She asked what the City Clerk's Office was doing, what have they been doing, what were they doing now, and what did they want to do.

Mayor Ryan asked for a survey of city clerk offices to find out what the size and duties of other offices were.

Commissioner Douglas asked for a memo to guide their decision. He agreed with surveying Pembroke Pines and Miramar among others, which explained the structure of the departments.

Commissioner Guzman added that she supported the additional position, but not the pay increase.

Mayor Ryan asked for consensus about the position.

Commissioner Douglas commented that the position could be funded mid-year. Generally, he supported a Charter Officer stating an additional position was needed. Regarding the salary scale, he asked for additional information.

Mayor Ryan asked for a consensus again on the position.

All agreed to add it.

Mayor Ryan asked for consensus regarding the pay range increase for the Deputy City Clerk position. He said Commissioner Guzman was a no.

Commissioner Douglas stated he was a no for now.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto advised he had a problem with all of the other department increases.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch was open to it.

Mayor Ryan suggested following up on this matter at the next meeting.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto commented that he had an issue with Sunrise being compared to other cities. Sunrise was a small city, but had the second largest tourist attraction in the State. It had the fourth largest utility system. It had the fourth largest corporate park in the State. It was the only city that had so many charter officer positions. He did not like Sunrise offices being compared to other cities. They knew how much work the City Clerk's Office did, because they saw all of the requests. They knew how many boards the City had. City Clerk Felicia Bravo spoke about things she would like to do with the department, but could not get to because she did not have enough time. The City Manager's Office has expanded over the years. He did not care what the other cities did. Sunrise was unique and the other cities wish they were us. The City Commission Office only had one person and a temp. Deputy Mayor Scuotto said with such a small department, the City Clerk needed additional help. He did not want to gut the department, but to move forward.

Mayor Ryan added that it would be interesting to know what other city clerk offices did, but he was confident that if they were doing the agenda and managing other departments, they had more than five employees.

Commissioner Guzman commented that if anyone's scale should change, it should be Lourdes Lawrence's pay.

Commissioner Douglas discussed the all fund summaries. He asked for the reason they budgeted \$11M, projected \$12M and budgeted \$13.2M. He asked where the projection came from.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith said they projected increases in electric utility service tax and franchise fee. The City did not control the tax rate. It was based on consumption and increased based on the rate as well. The City was conservative in its revenue projections because they did not want to fall short.

Commissioner Douglas replied that being off by 20% was a big difference.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith answered that more power usage based due to weather impacted the amounts. They could look into it further.

Commissioner Douglas commented about the permits and fees.

City Manager Mark Lubelski said the projection for this line item would be short. They calculated this based on developments that sometimes did not move forward. It was a challenge to project. One project could make a difference.

Commissioner Douglas discussed franchise fees. This year the budget projected more than last year. Intergovernmental revenue was going down.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith replied this also included grant funding. It could fluctuate depending upon when the grant was received. She asked him to keep in mind ARPA funding, which was a one-time payment.

Commissioner Douglas commented about budgeting for fees. He asked what those fees were.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith explained that it included utility income as well.

Commissioner Douglas asked about miscellaneous revenue. He asked about the difference from last year to the upcoming budget.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith replied that it was city-wide. Some was interest and investment earnings. Some fund balances had to be maintained for enterprise funds. Across them all, there has been an increase. She could provide more details.

Discussion continued regarding the accounting of dollars.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith stated that the City has not spent all of the ARPA money. The money was re-appropriated this year. I had to be spent by December 31, 2026 and encumbered by December 31, 2024.

Page 6 - Human Resources

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked to utilize interns wherever possible.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch and Commissioner Guzman had no issues.

Page 8 - City-Wide Pay Adjustments

Deputy Mayor Scuotto thought that the proposed changes to the City Commission Office staffing should not be addressed. It was not budgeted. He needed to have discussion with staff. The staff may be able to tell them what was needed.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch thought it should be fleshed out. He did not know who was going to back Lourdes up. He was not ready to discuss it tonight. It should be placed on an agenda.

Commissioner Guzman agreed with Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch, but wanted to make sure it came back sooner than next year.

City Manager Mark Lubelski stated it could be handled as a budget amendment.

Commissioner Douglas believed the office had changed. The Clerk has discussed how the office had changed. The Commission Aide has to handle the agenda and the Constant Contact. Sunrise was not a small city. It was not homogenous. It could not have been anticipated that social media would impact the office. It was untenable that one person did this for everyone. They were pleased with Lourdes' work. Other cities had Commission Aides for themselves. Sometimes they wanted a dedicated staff member. He thought it deserved more discussion.

Commissioner Guzman asked about part-time. It would be difficult to have someone who would stay for part-time work. She wanted the position should have benefits.

Commissioner Douglas agreed. Someone would need a second job. There was also the issue of whether they needed a full-time staffer for each elected official.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked if the position would be full-time.

Mayor Ryan commented that everyone had to comply with Human Resources. There were liability issues. There had to be a supervisor.

Page 9

The Gas Department had pay range changes, which was supported by Deputy Mayor Scuotto. He recommended advertising up north.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch thought that eliminating the disparity was essential.

Commissioner Guzman agreed.

Commissioner Douglas did not know the dollar figure between the ranges. He thought that changing salaries for internal equity was an issue.

City Manager Mark Lubelski explained that people moved to parallel positions because the pay range was different.

Commissioner Douglas supported it, as did Mayor Ryan.

Page 10

Deputy Mayor Scuotto commented that the IT pay ranges were lifted by 5%, and this was another raise.

City Manager Mark Lubelski stated it was a lump sum payment.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto advised that the City could not provide raises to police and fire, so he was not interested in continuing to get raises. The raises could not be given to Police and Fire.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch advised that the IT personnel were being sniped by other agencies.

Commissioner Guzman supported the raises.

Commissioner Douglas looked at the IT Department salaries and they were significantly underpaid. It was hard to hire and keep them here. He did not think that the IT Director could be retained at the bottom of the scale. He thought they were underpaid and employees would not be found. He discussed the individual steps for some of the positions.

City Manager Mark Lubelski added that the technical support analyst would have multiple levels and increased pay. It was a comprehensive solution. He asked IT staff where they wanted to go. They learned there was not enough laddering opportunities.

Commissioner Douglas asked if the City went into the marketplace to find out what the IT positions paid.

City Manager Mark Lubelski said a comprehensive analysis was conducted and he would share that information with the Commission. There were not enough laddering positions available in the department.

Mayor Ryan thought that the City may be looking at it from a past perspective. If IT failed, the City would fail. He appreciated Mr. PierreLouis' work.

Page 13

City Manager Mark Lubelski segued to the pay increases.

City Manager Mark Lubelski stated that once they did the pay analysis for it, they found a discrepancy in the pay range in the directors' range and also the deputy directors. In addition, they included the Deputy City Manager and Assistant City Manager position. This increase allows for the pay to be aligned with what is paid for these positions.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto stated that he would like to have received more information as far as the dollar amounts that showed the discrepancies in pay. He stated that when Fire and Police came through, they did it one at a time instead of all at one time. It would be a huge amount. He stated that he would have appreciated previous notice in reference to all the increases coming all at one time.

City Manager Lubelski apologized, he stated that various reclassifications have taken place throughout the organization. He stated this may be one of the last pieces.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto knew they were negotiating with general employees. He asked about those that were topped out. For those who were topped out, it was not fair.

City Manager Mark Lubelski commented over the past four years, there were increases. Right now, the internal inequities needed to be addressed.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch would like to see the future impacts going forward.

Commissioner Douglas this was not personal. Internal equity did not mean equality. Every single position was not the same because of the title. He was tempted to say that one department was not equal another department. Each was expected to perform to a standard. He gave examples. He asked if the Assistant City Manager was more important than the Deputy Directors.

City Manager Mark Lubelski explained that all directors reported to either the Deputy City Manager or the Assistant City Manager. He wanted to be able to ladder employees from the director positions.

Commissioner Douglas asked who was leaving due to pay in the City Manager's Office.

City Manager Mark Lubelski responded that the Assistant Building Official was leaving for the Seminole Tribe.

Commissioner Douglas again reiterated that all of the Deputy Directors would start at the same pay. He again asked how many people left due to pay among the directors.

City Manager Mark Lubelski answered that the base salary was of Deputy Directors and Directors was six step differences. There were multiple Assistant Directors to help. The work expectations were the same.

Commissioner Douglas disagreed with the net fishing. There were many who were at the top of the scale. They could not get any more merit increases. He asked what signal was sent to all of those who were not Deputy Directors. He spoke about salary study that was thrown out. But now we have internal studies that say there were inequities.

Commissioner Guzman agreed with what everyone was saying. She wanted to see the numbers of what they were making. She just wanted it to be fair.

Mayor Ryan asked to move to the charities. He announced more money requested than money allotted.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto said the ones that were matched should be funded at least what they were funded last year. Two new organizations put in for \$50K.

Charlotte Mather-Taylor commented that the Area Agency on Aging was serving more individuals. They would be grateful for whatever they received. They were matched and have more individuals. They were serving more people in one quarter than they did in the totality of last year.

Mayor Ryan agreed there would be a greater need due to other factors.

Commissioner Douglas made his proposals and stated the Commission could reconcile.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch wanted to hold the line with previous charities, then distribute the rest to the remainder of the charities.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto said JAFCO was a long-term partner in the City with multiple facilities. He suggested \$5,000 each.

Commissioner Douglas spoke about ARPA funds.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto replied that the ARPA funds could be used for something else. There constantly would be more people who wanted money. It would only be used one time for a charity.

Commissioner Douglas suggested a that ARPA was meant for this type of spending.

City Manager Mark Lubelski stated that there were some ARPA funds available.

Commissioner Douglas spoke about ARPA and how the federal government made it as flexible as possible. Charitable giving and community partners were part of ARPA. If the City spent some of the money on these groups, they may not get the money next year.

Commissioner Guzman thought everyone who received money previously should receive money this year. She thought that the Sunrise Chamber should receive more. She had no idea Farm Share submitted a request. She said to hold everyone at the same level as last year. She also stated she did not know about Heartsflow. She supported Freedom Flight South Florida. She supported both of JAFCO's requests. Goodman Family Services she was unsure about. She did not know about the Rotary Club. The Special Olympics did good work, but it was a big increase. She had some questions about the impact of Book Don't Match the Cover.

Mayor Ryan said Heartsflow and Farm Share both asked for \$50k each. He needed to understand why they asked for so much for their first request.

Commissioner Douglas replied many organizations did what Heartsflow did.

Commissioner Guzman thought that the Police Department had a good homeless program.

Commissioner Douglas advised homelessness was a big problem. However, this money came from ad valorem taxes, which were property taxes. The City took about 25% of property taxes and provided the most services. He asked if people wanted their property taxes to be given away to charities.

Mayor Ryan asked to go through previously funded charities for consensus:

Double Dutch Club	\$4,000
Freedom Flight	\$5,000
Areawide Council on Aging	\$50,000
Autism Speaks	\$10,000
Early Learning Coalition	\$30,000
National Scholastic Chess	\$35,000
Sunrise Chamber	\$9,750
Voices for Children	\$5,000

Mayor Ryan returned to the new requests. He was not sure about Farm Share.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch wanted to hold off on Farm Share. He wanted to see where the other charities were first.

Mayor Ryan asked about JAFCO and JAFCO Ability Center, which both requested \$10,000. All agreed to give them \$10,000. All agreed to give Special Olympics \$13,900.

Mayor Ryan loved the idea of a Rotary Club community garden; however, community gardens were expensive and complicated. He did not want to fund this project because the money would not help due to the expenses. All agreed to not fund it. Mayor Ryan mentioned Book Don't Match the Cover.

Commissioner Douglas replied he did not want to fund it.

Mayor Ryan said they were working with the Police Department.

Mayor Ryan commented that International Street Outreach (ISO) had a big request. He did not think that paying bills was a good idea. It would take a lot of reporting. The organization was already operating and they should be able to pay their overhead.

Commissioner Douglas asked Book Don't Match the Cover (BDMC) to come forward.

Nadine Cutno, BDMC, came forward to state that many foster care kids aged out and were trafficked. Her organization worked with the Police Department. They strived to have aged-out children become skilled. They trained trafficking victims. It was needed especially among youth.

Mayor Ryan responded that the City worked with MJ Scarlett Foundation.

Commissioner Guzman reminded everyone that Ms. Cutno received a proclamation last year. She asked how long she has been doing this. She asked what organizations she worked with.

Ms. Cutno began in 2020, but started the organization last year. She named the agencies she worked with. The money was used for renting a venue and supplies. They wanted to work with the Boys and Girls Club of Sunrise. She had not requested funding in the past from anyone.

Commissioner Douglas asked when it began and she answered last year. He asked who was being compensated with an \$8,000 salary.

Ms. Cutno explained that there were collaborations with other organizations. She commented that she was worked with Tamara Dawes in the past. The video would be used for training purposes.

It was explained that Tamara Dawes was a Sunrise employee now.

Mayor Ryan called ISO forward. He commented that it seemed like the City would pay for International Street Outreach's (ISO) overhead. He did not know exactly what they were asking the City to specifically fund. They were already in the community. Sunrise usually did not fund the faith-based community directly.

The ISO representative, Camille Abraham, replied they work on the east side and do not get much funding. Everyone was a volunteer. With the increased need, they needed assistance.

Mayor Ryan asked where they received the money for the church.

Ms. Abraham responded that they donated their own money. The church did not get much money from the community. They also asked friends for money.

Commissioner Douglas said that not all chartable organizations were churches. It was tricky when a church was involved.

Ms. Abraham replied ISO was not the church, but the church gave it money.

Commissioner Douglas commented that they owned the distribution site, but asked for money to rent the distribution site.

Ms. Abraham answered she charged the church and the outreach rent.

Commissioner Douglas said he saw some charities that did not do work, but he has seen them distribute. Sometimes there was a blurred separation from the church. He gave examples of situations. These were tax dollars. Church and state were usually tried to keep separate. He had concerns about the religious aspect.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked what she did for the community.

Ms. Abraham explained that they delivered boxes of groceries to families. They served 70 families every Tuesday. They ministered to youth to guide them. On the second and fourth Saturday of the month they did food distribution.

Commissioner Douglas asked about a prohibition on a one-time use of ARPA funding.

Mayor Ryan commented that many faith-based communities did not apply because the City did not fund churches. He said he has spoken to many pastors that were on the verge of collapse. If the City gave this organization money, all churches would come forward next year.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto stated that it seemed like they were coupled with the church based on their paperwork. They were on the same site. He wondered if there was another way to assist. The work they did was huge. He had no problem helping them in a different way.

Commissioner Guzman thought they should receive \$5,000.

Mayor Ryan agreed that they did great work, but the City would have a problem. Mayor Ryan did not think there was enough money left to give Farm Share.

Commissioner Guzman commented she had nothing to do with Farm Share applying.

Commissioner Douglas said the City was providing services to Farm Share and it came with a cost.

Commissioner Guzman commented she would meet with them and see what else their needs were. Perhaps it could be contemplated next year.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch supported giving \$1,600 to BDMC. He suggested making up the difference with ARPA funding.

Mayor Ryan believed it was better to see what they were doing and hold the line at the target amount.

Page 15

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch asked if Police had all of the resources they needed to do their job effectively and Police Chief Daniel Ransone replied yes.

Commissioner Douglas spoke about the body-worn camera for the K-9 officer. He asked if the K-9 would ever be let off the leash with the camera on.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone said the dog had a vantage point. The dog was deployed on leash, but sometimes forward of the officer. They could see what the K-9 sees remotely. It could record action as well.

Commissioner Douglas did not want to see a dog deployed where there was no control of the dog.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone answered the dog was always under control of the handler. There has never been a K-9 BWC in Sunrise, but it has been used for years in other jurisdictions. They had a specific dog in mind for this task.

Commissioner Douglas asked about the license plate readers (LPRs). He asked about the \$204,000 for professional services.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone replied it was the annual cost for 34 locations, 68 cameras, in and out of the city. There would be a one-time cost and recurring cost. They would be 81 cameras.

Commissioner Douglas asked if they would need additional cameras.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone thought 100 cameras could be needed. After the initial camera were installed, they would determine what else needed to be covered. The annual cost would go up with additional cameras. The grant he applied for would not be reoccurring.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith stated there was a one-time \$1 million federal grant. The funding was allocated in the budget. It could be used for additional projects.

Mayor Ryan asked about the grant. He asked what the City requested to pay from the grant.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith stated she would need to look at the application.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone explained the grant would not cover recurring costs. He explained that the budget request for 68 cameras for \$248,000 was in forfeiture funds. He may need additional funding. About \$44,000 would be a one-time set up cost. The \$204,000 would be for the cameras annually.

Commissioner Douglas asked how much they thought they needed this program.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone commented the 34 locations were at major ingress and egress locations of the City. It would require 68 cameras. Once installed, they would have to analyze the program.

Commissioner Douglas asked about the grant money and how it could be used, since it could not be used for recurring costs.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith said the grant was secured for community crime reduction. It may have been specific to hardware and software. Each grant was unique.

Commissioner Douglas asked if forfeiture funds could be used in the future and was told no, because they were a one-time funding source. He was told it would have to go out for RFP. The LPRs were Flock-based cameras, so multiple vendors could respond.

Mayor Ryan thanked him for bringing this forward.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked how much the City paid for the 13 cameras.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone said that the City saved money by signing the three-year contract and paid nothing for the 13 red-light cameras.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto agreed about the cost, but thought it was worth the money. He asked about speed cameras, which could generate additional money. He spoke about the school zone cameras and the bus cameras. It was less expensive to pay the ticket for the bus violation than to get a ticket. He asked about the pay increases for Police and Fire for majors and captains. He asked if he had a study about police pay. If a correction was needed, he would like to know. He asked if the Police Department had all of the equipment they needed to map out crime scenes and traffic accidents. He was told yes. He asked about the motorcycle officers. Many did not want to ride a motorcycle.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone replied that the City would continue to have motorcycle officers. He said the City was sufficiently budgeted for staffing, but about 10% short in personnel, which was about 11 vacancies. They hired people, but were a little short.

Commissioner Guzman asked about a school zone study.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone replied he did not have the study. It said that speeding in a school zone was a problem. He met with multiple vendors that worked in that area. He could bring a program forward, if that was the direction from the Commission. He has been preparing to move forward. It was similar to a red-light cameras or license plate readers.

Commissioner Guzman asked if the community would be advised about the LPRs. Coral Springs let people know. Coral Springs tracked and put video online so people understood they would be caught. She wanted Sunrise to tell the community that Sunrise was a hard target for crime.

Commissioner Douglas asked about the overtime budget. It was challenging. He asked if the overtime budget met the needs of the department.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone said the overtime budget was \$1.8 million. This year would be around \$1.6 million. It was a fair number.

Commissioner Douglas wanted a real number for budget lines. He did not like money being transferred from account to account. He asked if he has been able to keep the community safe.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone answered that the \$1.8 million was a fair number. If he had to ask for more, there would be a good reason.

Commissioner Douglas asked about speeding and police visibility.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone explained that the department was reorganized. The people were where they needed to be.

Commissioner Douglas asked if they revisited how many people needed to be in particular locations.

Police Chief Daniel Ransone advised that was a constant task. They always evaluated where officers needed to be deployed.

Mayor Ryan liked that the overtime was being watched. He thought they were doing a good job.

Page 17 – Fire Rescue

Mayor Ryan asked about mental health issues with first responders. How could it be improved and how was that done through our self-insured program.

Fire Chief John McNamara said that the City had 5 firefighters commit suicide and 3 others attempted. Sunrise has good insurance and programs. There could be additional opportunities that were untraditional, but no way to guarantee success. He wondered where he could find the best help for the few that come forward. The regular paths did not work for police and fire. Sometimes the police Baker Acted people and a few weeks later when they needed help, were placed in the same facility as the criminal they Baker Acted. It was a preventative hurdle.

Mayor Ryan agreed. He wanted to make sure they had the resources.

Fire Chief John McNamara responded there was good collaboration between agencies, but room for improvement. There was peer-to-peer collaboration. Every department would want to have one locally.

Mayor Ryan said some were afraid because they may be deemed unfit for duty.

Fire Chief John McNamara replied it was good that Florida had PTSD laws. If people could not recover, there would be financial problems for younger firefighters.

Commissioner Guzman stated she saw the buddy system in another City for firefighters. It was rolled out to other staff. She asked if he could reach out to them to see how it could be used here.

Fire Chief John McNamara replied the chief advocate was doing good job and many jurisdictions were looking at that. Many were trying to see if they could do that logistically and financially.

Commissioner Guzman said they could have a lunch and learn session. She asked about after the fire, the Fire Still Burns program. She knew a family that lost their home to fire and it went on for quite some time. She reached out to Representative Debbie Wasserman-Shultz about assistance for the family and was directed to some County resources. She asked why the City did not have a program for emergency services like this. She would like it expanded in some way because people who had fires lost keys to cars, their driver's license. With CPR mannequins, she asked about an official license.

Fire Chief John McNamara answered that most people were trying to get the card, but could not any longer. They contemplated doing CPR training at events or high schools.

Commissioner Guzman asked for the training to rotate through the high schools. She asked about smoke alarms.

Fire Chief John McNamara responded that they used to partner with the Red Cross and receive free alarms. They would advertise in communities. They would install the alarms. The community paramedic checks when people do not have smoke detectors. They would send people out to address it.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch supported the Fire Still Burns program. It had immediate vouchers.

Fire Chief John McNamara explained that the Red Cross gave people cards with a few hundred dollars, but hotels would not take the cards. The people could go to an ATM, but the hotels did not take cash. To show up on a call and provide some shelter for a couple of nights was good. He stated that they have hotels for heroes for two or three nights. They partner with restaurants for food for the victims of fire. Sometimes they gave people flip-flops because they did not have socks or shoes when they fled the building. It took a while for insurance to show up, if they had it. It was also important to educate people about insurance.

Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch asked if they had everything they needed.

Fire Chief John McNamara answered he did.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked about the new radios and if they were a problem.

Fire Chief John McNamara replied no. They worked well. They tested the equipment within the schools.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked if the radios were tested in new developments.

Fire Chief John McNamara explained it was part of the development review process. The City did the test regardless of whether the developer was told it was not needed.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked about pediatric airway mannequins.

Fire Chief John McNamara explained the use was part of the training.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto requested Fire Chief John McNamara to provide information about salary study comparisons to other department, just as he asked of Police Chief Daniel Ransone.

Fire Chief John McNamara said that he would provide the information. The staff received the increase.

Page 18 - Impact Study and Corporate Park Study

Deputy Mayor Scuotto requested City Manager Mark Lubelski to provide additional information in reference to the Corporate Park Study and Impact Study. He wanted to know what could go in the different vacant lots.

City Manager Mark Lubelski advised that there has not been a change in impact fees since his time here and one is long overdue.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto stated that he met with County Commissioners and some of the issues regarding impact fees were discussed. Mr. Viola would have the rights to develop a property, but wanted to make sure Sunrise was at the table. The other issue was Sunrise Sports and Entertainment. Whatever support was needed, the Commission should be contacted.

Page 19 - Leisure Services

Mayor Ryan stated he asked City Manager Mark Lubelski and Leisure Services Director Kevin Pickard to reach out to other municipalities and find out what they

do for veterans. The City already holds a breakfast for veterans, but they should reach out to assisted living facilities as well.

Commissioner Guzman said other cities conduct Dive-In Theaters. She had questions in reference to the theatre seating and asked if the City had plans to change the seating in the theatre.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith stated that the project was in the Capital Outlay. It would fund several updates in the theater including seating and flooring replacements. The design needed to be completed, which would take 6 – 9 months. The construction would be in next year's budget.

Commissioner Douglas agreed that there needed to be some remodeling of the theater. He asked questions in reference to how the ballroom would be managed.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith stated that we would not be providing the food for rentals at the ballroom. Residents will be able to bring their own food.

Commissioner Douglas asked for clarification in reference guidelines for bringing in food. He asked if the City would specify how the food would be provided.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto replied that once someone had a Sterno, it was that person's responsibility.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith stated that it would handled the same as in the City's other facilities. People could bring their own food, and if they were hiring a caterer, the City would require insurance.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto stated that he wanted to make sure that there were guardrails on the program that would ensure that the renovated facilities would be protected from possible damage.

Commissioner Douglas asked about keeping Tunes 'N Trucks rotating through the City.

City Manager Mark Lubelski replied that staff understood the direction of the Commission and would continue rotations in the future.

Commissioner Douglas asked in reference to Village Multipurpose if there was any plan for renovations or changes there, specifically with audio visual.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith advised that it was already completed.

Commissioner Douglas also had a question in reference to the purchase of heavy equipment in the budget. He asked if it was needed specifically under the Leisure Department and if it could not be placed under the Public Works Division.

City Manager Mark Lubelski explained that Leisure had its own maintenance team. It was a replacement.

Commissioner Douglas asked about the Christmas Lights enhancement.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith replied that there would be some food trucks to enhance the event.

Commissioner Douglas commented that people were in line for the hot chocolate, but thought they wanted to stay and have fun. He also thought the entertainment could be better. He thought this would be the City's biggest event in the future.

Page 20 – no comments

Page 21

Mayor Ryan had a question in reference to Freebie asked how it could be expanded beyond the western district of the City. He asked City Manager Mark Lubelski to please come back with a strategy to expand the service.

Deputy Mayor Scuotto asked in reference to the bus system, if there could be a route added to go to the new supermarket on University Drive as well.

Page 22

Commissioner Douglas asked in reference to the Oscar Wind Park, what was being redesigned.

City Manager Mark Lubelski stated that there was a report. There will be information on an upcoming agenda with specifics.

Commissioner Douglas asked what was incorporated in the 22/23 design. And was told it was the design for the theatre.

Page 23 – no comments

Page 24 – no comments

Page 25 – no comments

Page 26 – no comments

Page 27 – no comments

Page 28

Mayor Ryan asked about the changes on membership to ensure that the residents received adequate tee times.

City Manager Mark Lubelski answered the program may need additional changes.

Page 29

Commissioner Douglas asked if the new fleet management software was covered under the \$12 million in the Fleet Division budget.

City Manager Mark Lubelski stated that acquiring the software was covered under this budget, but the recurring expense would be covered here.

Page 30 – no comments

Page 31

Mayor Ryan asked if CDD was good with staffing.

City Manager Mark Lubelski stated there was sufficient staffing. The City would be recruiting for Building Official position.

Page 32 – no comments

Page 33 – no comments

Page 36

Mayor Ryan advised this page was regarding ARPA.

City Manager Mark Lubelski said that the funding was consistent with previous discussions the Commission had on ARPA programming. The only change was the reduction in the Blue Tarp funding, which was based on the applications the City already had.

Mayor Ryan asked if there was a need to amend the tentative budget.

Deputy City Manager Emilie Smith replied it was not needed.

Mayor Ryan asked for a roll call on Item 5A, the millage resolution.

Roll Call:

Commissioner Douglas	Yea
Commissioner Guzman	Yea
Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch	Yea
Deputy Mayor Scuotto	Yea
Mayor Ryan	Yea

Mayor Ryan asked for a roll call on Item 5E, the FY 24/25 budget ordinance.

Roll Call:

Commissioner Douglas	Yea
Commissioner Guzman	Yea
Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch	Yea
Deputy Mayor Scuotto	Yea
Mayor Ryan	Yea

(B) Fire Rescue Assessment
C24225 Resolution No. 24-83-24-A

A Resolution of the City of Sunrise, Florida, relating to the provision of Fire Rescue Services, Facilities and Programs in the City of Sunrise, Florida; Reimposing Fire Rescue Assessments against Assessed Property located within the City of Sunrise for the Fiscal Year beginning October 1, 2024; approving the rate of assessment; approving the assessment roll; and providing an effective date. City Manager Mark Lubelski. Susan Nabors, Director of Finance and Administrative Services.

MOTION A motion to approve Item 5B made by Deputy Mayor Scuotto was seconded by Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch.

Mayor Ryan opened a public hearing. No one came forward to speak.

Mayor Ryan closed the public hearing.

Roll Call:

Commissioner Douglas	Yea
Commissioner Guzman	Yea
Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch	Yea
Deputy Mayor Scuotto	Yea
Mayor Ryan	Yea

(C) Parking Garage Assessment
C24226 Resolution No. 15-193-24-A

A Resolution of the City of Sunrise, Florida, relating to the Parking Garages Assessment Area and adopting the Annual Rate Resolution for Fiscal Year

City Commission Meeting
First Budget Hearing FY 2024/2025
September 12, 2024

2024/2025; approving the assessment roll; providing for severability; and providing for an effective date. City Manager Mark Lubelski. Susan Nabors, Director of Finance and Administrative Services.

MOTION A motion to approve Item 5C made by Deputy Mayor Scuotto was seconded by Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch.

Mayor Ryan opened a public hearing. No one came forward to speak.

Mayor Ryan closed the public hearing.

Roll Call:

Commissioner Douglas	Yea
Commissioner Guzman	Yea
Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch	Yea
Deputy Mayor Scuotto	Yea
Mayor Ryan	Yea

(D) Nuisance Abatement Assessment
C24211 Resolution No. 24-82-24-A

A Resolution of the City of Sunrise, Florida, adopting the Assessment Roll for Nuisance Abatement for the time period of June 1, 2023 through May 31, 2024, with interest calculated through October 31, 2024; and providing for an effective date. City Manager Mark Lubelski. Susan Nabors, Director of Finance and Administrative Services.

MOTION A motion to approve Item 5A made by Deputy Mayor Scuotto was seconded by Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch.

Mayor Ryan opened a public hearing. No one came forward to speak.

Mayor Ryan closed the public hearing.

Roll Call:

Commissioner Douglas	Yea
Commissioner Guzman	Yea
Assistant Deputy Mayor Kerch	Yea
Deputy Mayor Scuotto	Yea
Mayor Ryan	Yea

Adjournment

Seeing no further business, the meeting adjourned at 12:00 a.m.

Respectfully submitted by:

Felicia M. Bravo, City Clerk